

Slides 0.3: Decisions Step by Step

Lesson 0.3, Unit 0. One period. Twelve slides.

Slide 1: Do now

- Your family has to pick one thing for dinner tonight and everyone wants something different.
- How does it get decided in your house?
- One sentence. Be honest.

Notes: Four answers on the board: one person decides; the loudest wins; we vote; we take turns. They come back on slide 10.

Slide 2: The situation

- A small plane. The north woods. Late October.
- Engine fails. Hard landing on a lake shore. Everyone walks away.
- The pilot's distress call went out. Searchers know the area, about twenty miles across.
- Nearest town: forty miles through forest. No road.
- 35 F by day. Below freezing at night. Dark at 6. It is 2 in the afternoon.

Image: a lake shore with a small plane on it, trees behind, a low sun.

Notes: Read the full scenario from the handout aloud. The lake water needs boiling.

Slide 3: Ten things survived

- A: orange tarp, 12 by 12 feet. B: waterproof matches. C: metal pot with a lid.
- D: first aid kit. E: three wool blankets. F: loud whistle.
- G: flashlight, fresh batteries. H: 24 granola bars. I: folding knife. J: road map of the state.

Image: the ten items drawn in a row, each with its letter.

Slide 4: Rank alone

- Silence. No looking at a neighbor.
- Rank 1 (most important for surviving until searchers find you) to 10.
- Write the letters in the Alone column.
- One word of reason for your number 1.
- Eight minutes.

Notes: Watch the loudest voice at each table. That is the person the next step tests.

Slide 5: Rank as a team

- One team ranking.
- Every person has to be able to say why for the top three.

- No voting on the whole list. Talk through each item. Move the cards.
- Sentence starter: "I think ___ is number ___ because ___."
- Ten minutes. The reset cue ends it.

Notes: Circulate. Note per table: who talks first, who does not talk, whether anyone asks a quiet person. One observation per table for slide 10.

Slide 6: The expert ranking, 1 to 5

- 1 B, matches: fire is warmth, a signal, and boiled water. The first night below freezing is the biggest danger.
- 2 E, wool blankets: warmth for four, even damp.
- 3 A, orange tarp: shelter from wind and rain, and a search plane can see it.
- 4 C, pot with a lid: the lake is your water, and it has to be boiled.
- 5 F, whistle: three blasts; carries farther than a voice; costs no energy.

Notes: Reveal one at a time with the reason. Students copy into the Expert column.

Slide 7: The expert ranking, 6 to 10

- 6 G, flashlight: signal at night, move safely. Batteries run out.
- 7 D, first aid kit: nobody is badly hurt; keeps small things small.
- 8 I, folding knife: useful, not lifesaving by itself.
- 9 H, granola bars: food is the last thing you run out of. Ration them.
- 10 J, road map: town is forty miles away and searchers know where you are. Stay with the plane.

Notes: The map is the teaching item. Almost every team ranks it too high because walking feels like doing something.

Slide 8: Score it

- For each item: the difference between your rank and the expert rank. Ignore the minus sign.
- Example: you put the matches at 4. The expert put them at 1. The difference is 3.
- Add the ten differences. Lower is better.
- Do it for the Alone column and the Team column.

Image: one row of the table worked on the board.

Notes: Seven minutes. Walk and read totals. Two totals the same means the alone column was overwritten.

Slide 9: The numbers

- Table 1: average alone ____, team ____
- Table 2: average alone ____, team ____
- Table 3: average alone ____, team ____
- Table 4: average alone ____, team ____

- Did the team beat the average? Did it beat the best person?

Notes: In most rooms the team beats the average and often the best individual. Ask the table where it did not what happened to the best person's idea.

Slide 10: What you just did: five steps

- 1 Name the choice: what do we need to survive until rescue?
- 2 List options: the ten cards.
- 3 Weigh each against what matters: cold first, then water, then being seen, then food. Searchers are coming.
- 4 Decide: the team ranking.
- 5 Look back: the score and the reasons.

Image: five boxes in a row with an icon each: a question mark, a list, a scale, a check mark, a mirror.

Notes: "This is how we decide in this room all year: a recipe, a budget, a design, a product. Five steps, same words." Share one observation per table, no names. Point back to the do now answers: which of the four ways your families decide has all five steps?

Slide 11: Exit card

- The five steps in order. Handout turned over.
- My alone score and my team score.
- The one item I would still rank differently from the expert, and my reason.
- Three people read line three aloud.

Notes: A defensible disagreement with the key is doing the lesson right. Say so.

Slide 12: Tomorrow

- Tomorrow: water, rice, four measurements, and a team.
- Nobody may say a word.
- Then you write your own team rules.